Seven Altars Can’t Buy One Word from God

John P. Kennon
Manuscript excerpt

SEVEN ALTARS CAN'T BUY ONE WORD FROM GOD

Religion, Revelation, and the Fire That Still Falls

A Journey from the Mountains of Moab to the Upper Room

John P. Kennon

Opening Scripture

"Behold, I have received commandment to bless: and he hath blessed; and I cannot reverse it."

— Numbers 23:20

Author's Preface

There are moments in Scripture when God pulls back the curtain and allows us to see not merely the events of history, but the principles that govern His Kingdom. The account of Balaam and Balak is one of those moments. At first glance it appears to be the story of a frightened king, a reluctant prophet, and a series of sacrifices offered upon lonely mountains overlooking the plains of Moab. Yet beneath the surface lies one of the most profound revelations in all of Scripture.

This is not simply the story of seven altars.

It is the story of humanity's relentless attempt to reach God through its own effort, while God continually reveals that He cannot be manipulated by ambition, purchased through religion, or persuaded to violate His own Word.

Balak believed more altars would produce another answer.

God had already spoken.

Centuries later, another group of people gathered—not upon a mountain, but in an upper room in Jerusalem. They possessed no altars, no sacrifices, no priesthood, and no earthly power. They had only the promise of Jesus Christ and hearts humbled by revelation. They did not attempt to persuade heaven. They simply waited in obedient faith.

Then heaven came down. The contrast could not be greater.

One mountain was filled with smoke but no new word.

One room was filled with fire because God's final Word had already been revealed in Jesus Christ.

This book traces that journey. From the mountains of Moab to the cross. From the cross to the Upper Room. From the Upper Room to the Church. And from the Church to every heart that

still longs for the fire of God to fall today.

For the central question has never changed.

Can religion bring man to God?

Or…

**Has God always intended to reveal Himself to those who humbly receive His Word?

The answer echoes from every page of Scripture.

Not by ambition. Not by manipulation. Not by human effort.

But by revelation.

Fear has built more altars than faith ever has. Throughout history, whenever men have believed God could be persuaded by human effort, mountains have filled with smoke but heaven has remained silent. Yet there is another way—a way not built upon ambition, but upon revelation. Our journey begins in the plains of Moab, where a frightened king looked across a valley and mistook the presence of God's people for a political problem, never realizing he was about to confront the unchanging character of God.

Journey One

A King Standing on a Wall

Primary Text: Numbers 22:1–6

Balak Summons Balaam

Num 22:1 Then the people of Israel set out and camped in the plains of Moab beyond the Jordan at Jericho.

Num 22:2 And Balak the son of Zippor saw all that Israel had done to the Amorites.

Num 22:3 And Moab was in great dread of the people, because they were many. Moab was overcome with fear of the people of Israel.

Num 22:4 And Moab said to the elders of Midian, “This horde will now lick up all that is around us, as the ox licks up the grass of the field.” So Balak the son of Zippor, who was king of Moab at that time,

Num 22:5 sent messengers to Balaam the son of Beor at Pethor, which is near the River in the land of the people of Amaw, to call him, saying, “Behold, a people has come out of Egypt. They cover the face of the earth, and they are dwelling opposite me.

Num 22:6 Come now, curse this people for me, since they are too mighty for me. Perhaps I shall be able to defeat them and drive them from the land, for I know that he whom you bless is blessed, and he whom you curse is cursed.”